



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Reduce! Reuse! Recycle! Stop throwing things away!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can say and use the sound *thr*.
- I can stress new information.
- I can identify key information in a short audio.

Ask your partner:

- How many items do you recycle every week? Every month?
- How important is it to reduce the number of things we throw away every day?
- Do you believe that celebrities have the power to influence people on social causes? Why or why not?

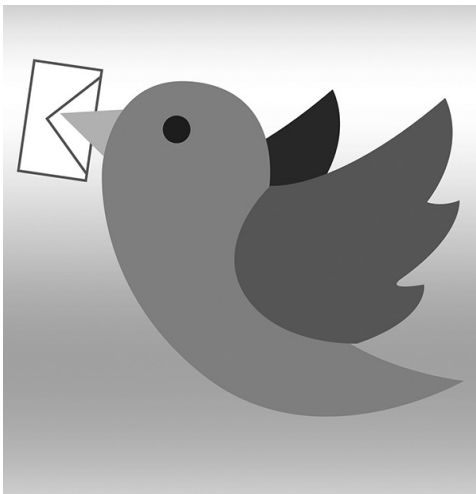




Let's Explore!

Sally asks about what needs to be done if we want to make climate change a thing of the past ... One **tweet*** at a time!

* Social media sites like *Twitter* have become very influential to raise awareness on important issues like climate change.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** John, I want to thank you for taking the time to go through this interview.
- John Smits:** The pleasure is all mine. I hope more people will be inspired to change their attitude towards the environment.
- Sally:** I'd like to ask you a few more questions from our readers.
- John Smits:** Of course. I'd be thrilled.
- Sally:** What is the greatest threat to the environment right now?
- John Smits:** I'd say that the amount of stuff we throw away every day is staggering.
- Sally:** How do you think the situation could be improved?
- John Smits:** Society needs to feel involved in this important matter. After the first wave of environmental treaties were signed 20 years ago, awareness programs were created throughout our country. That's a positive sign, but we need to work tirelessly if we want to see them thrive.
- Sally:** Would you say that irreparable damage was done by the previous generation?
- John Smits:** Yes, to a certain extent. Climate change wasn't studied by scientists as widely as it is now. People only started to notice once our cause was endorsed by movie stars!
- Sally:** So, do you believe that celebrities will save the day, one tweet at a time?
- John Smits:** Absolutely. Throngs of people follow them online. They have a duty to speak out for the earth!





Let's Practice!

Let's practice the words and sentences!

Instructions: Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor. Model a conversation with the sentences. Switch roles with a partner.

1. Through
2. Thrilled
3. Threat
4. Throw away
5. Throngs
6. Thrive
7. I want to thank you for taking the time to go through this interview.
8. Of course. I'd be thrilled.
9. What is the greatest threat to the environment now?
10. I'd say that the amount of stuff we throw away every day is staggering.
11. Absolutely. Throngs of people follow them online.
12. That's a positive sign, but we need to work tirelessly if we want to see them thrive.



Let's Practice!

Used cars might not be the best idea ...

Instructions: Choose words from the box to correctly complete the sentences.

choking / bought / covering / second / polluting / strange / large clouds / black / very
excited / kilometer / used / first

1. Last month, I was _____ because I _____ my _____ car.
2. I went to a car lot and looked around at all the _____ hand vehicles.
3. About a _____ down the street, the car started to make _____ noises and _____ of _____ smoke started coming out of it.
4. People on the street were _____ and _____ their mouths.
5. I was _____ the environment.





Extension Activity

Imagine a night out at the movies.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a short story (12-14 lines) about a movie you went to see.
- Who did you go with? What did you see? How was the movie?
- Describe your feelings about the movie.
- Use at least 4 words with the *Thr* sound, like *thrilling*.
- Read your paragraph to a partner, stressing new information.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I say and use the sound *thr*.

☐
☐

I stress new information.

☐
☐

I identify key information and make sentences.

☐
☐


Target Words

- **threat** (noun): something likely to cause damage or danger
e.g. What is the greatest threat to our environment right now?
- **throughout** (preposition): all the way through
e.g. Environmental awareness programs were created throughout the country.
- **tirelessly** (adverb): without pause
e.g. We need to work tirelessly if we want to defend the environment.
- **to thrive** (verb): to succeed; to prosper
e.g. We need to work tirelessly if we want to see these programs thrive.
- **irreparable** (adjective): impossible to repair
e.g. Would you say that irreparable damage was done by the previous generation?
- **to endorse** (verb): to support
e.g. People only started to notice once our cause was endorsed by movie stars!
- **throng** (noun): large number of people
e.g. Throngs of people follow movie stars online.





Learning Points

Consonant Blends: the *thr* Sound

Consonant clusters like *thr* can occur at the beginning of a word in English.

Practice blending the sound from one consonant sound into the next without adding a vowel sound in between.

Read the following words aloud.

Example:

through	thrilled	thrilling	throw
throughout	throng	thrive	threat

Examples:

- **Ann:** *What is the **greatest threat** to the environment right now?*
- **Bob:** *I'd say that the amount of stuff we **throw away** every day is staggering.*

Stressing New Information

When you want to stress new information, you use different intonation and stress on the "new" word or idea.

You usually stress content words in a sentence.

Content words are the words that carry the most meaning (nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs etc.).

When you use the Simple Past Passive, you stress the **verb in the past participle form**.

When you want to exchange opinions, you can choose to put the stress and the intonation on the "new" words. This helps the listener understand that you want to stress that word and that it is related to the opinions they want to give.

Look at the following examples:

*After the first wave of environmental treaties were **signed** 20 years ago, awareness programs were **created** throughout our country.*

*Climate change wasn't **studied** by scientists as widely as it is now.*

*People only started to notice once our cause was **endorsed** by movie stars!*

When you stress these "new" words, your voice will rise slightly (intonation).

